

Sander Dekker

Artist · Amsterdam, NL · b. 1980
Photography · Installation · Publication



BIOGRAPHY

Sander Dekker (Amsterdam, 1980) is an artist working with photography, installation and self-published books and zines.

His work centres on how people present themselves — to each other, to cameras, and to the world they build around themselves. The core of his practice is The Social Media Project, a decade-long series of encounters with strangers photographed in their own homes after first contact online. It caught something specific: a brief moment when reaching out to a stranger felt open, easy and charged with possibility. That openness is slowly disappearing.

The questions that project raised have continued to drive everything since — through permanent installations, handmade publications, participatory work, and ongoing projects centred on people who push back against external pressure simply by being fully, visibly themselves.

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Press Kit 2026

SELECTED PRESS

"While embracing his own strangeness, he makes a true connection with his models. It's what makes his work so very appealing."

Marloes van Vugt — foreword, My Name Is Sander Dekker N°.2

"It's a reflection of the zeitgeist: how normal it has become to show so much of yourself on social media, and how easy it was — or is — to make contact."

Margot Pol — de Volkskrant

"What makes his work so remarkable is the individuality and autonomy of his characters: they refuse to relinquish their power and above all: they seem to be unapologetically themselves."

Flor Linckens — Gallery Viewer

"Like Arbus, Clark and Sultan, Sander Dekker is a child of his time."

Edo Dijksterhuis — Het Parool



The Social Media Project

Photography · 2011–2021

In 2011, Dekker began reaching out to strangers on social media with a simple request: let me photograph you in your own home. Most said yes. A decade-long document of a specific kind of human openness — caught just before it closed. An archive of encounters that increasingly feel like they belong to another era.

[VIEW PROJECT →](#)



The Social Landscape (TenFifteen)

Installation · 2012–present

Thousands of black-and-white photographs, each ten by fifteen centimetres, presented side by side in a large-scale installation. Individually intimate. Together an overwhelming landscape that mirrors the endless social media scroll. Permanently installed at Hotel Not Hotel Amsterdam, Torch Gallery, Strayfield Gallery Copenhagen, and Leica Store Lisse.

[VIEW PROJECT →](#)



The Zine Project

Self-published · 2021–2025

Ten handmade, limited-edition zines made between 2021 and 2025 — each a short trip to Paris, Warsaw, Mexico, Amsterdam, Asia. No publisher, no brief, no compromises. All ten editions sold out. The complete set shown at Josilda da Conceição Gallery and Torch Gallery Amsterdam.

[VIEW PROJECT →](#)



Innate Curiosity

Installation · 2026–present

A series of physical installations that withhold — demanding that you lean in, reach in, look for yourself. Closed aluminium blinds concealing a backlit photograph. A railway bin containing a handmade 1980s magazine. What happens to curiosity when discovery is served rather than earned?

[VIEW PROJECT →](#)

SOLO EXHIBITIONS (SELECTION)

2025	Torch Gallery, Amsterdam NL
2023	Josilda da Conceição Gallery, Amsterdam NL
2022	Torch Gallery, Amsterdam NL
2020	Strayfield Gallery, Copenhagen DK
2018	Torch Gallery, Amsterdam NL
2018	Amsterdam Central Station NL
2016	30Works Gallery, Cologne DE
2015	Walls Gallery, Amsterdam NL

ART FAIRS (SELECTION)

2026	NAP+, Amsterdam NL
2024	NAP+, Amsterdam NL
2022	Unseen Amsterdam NL
2017	6voor6 Art Fair, Amsterdam NL
2015	KunstRAI, Amsterdam NL
2014	PAN Amsterdam NL

GROUP EXHIBITIONS (SELECTION)

2024	40Y Torch Gallery, Amsterdam NL
2022	Caesuur & Lípa, Middelburg NL
2022	Luxfer & Lípa, Česká Skalice CZ
2020	Strayfield Gallery, Hellerup DK
2018	Arti et Amicitiae, Amsterdam NL
2017	Josilda da Conceição, Amsterdam NL
2016	Bright Side Gallery, Amsterdam NL
2013	FOAM, Amsterdam NL
2013	Nuit Blanche, Amsterdam NL

PERMANENT INSTALLATIONS

2026	Leica Store, Lisse NL
2020	Strayfield Gallery, Hellerup DK
2018	Torch Gallery, Amsterdam NL
2018	Hotel Not Hotel, Amsterdam NL

PUBLICATIONS (SELECTION)

2025	The Zine Project — Collector's Box (all 10 zines)
2021–25	The Zine Project — 10 handmade limited-edition zines. All sold out.
2016	My Name Is Sander Dekker Vol. 2 — ISBN 9789082111330
2015	My Name Is Sander Dekker Vol. 1.5 — ISBN 9789082111323
2013	My Name Is Sander Dekker Vol. 1 — ISBN 9789082111316

ZINE PROJECT (SELECTION)

2025	N°10 TenFifteen · Ed. 150
2025	N°9 A.S.I.A. · Ed. 40
2024	N°8 The Warsaw SAGA · Ed. 40
2023	N°5 Mexico · Ed. 35
2022	N°2 Girls in Paris · Ed. 35
2021	N°1 Annemarijn · Ed. 25

Mother Gallery

Torch Art Gallery
Amsterdam, NL
mo@torchgallery.com
torchgallery.com

Special Projects

Josilda da Conceição Gallery
Amsterdam, NL
josilda@daconceicao.nl
josildadaconceicao.com

Denmark

Strayfield Gallery
Hellerup, DK
info@strayfieldgallery.com
strayfieldgallery.com

For exhibition proposals, press enquiries, artwork acquisition and collaborations —
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